Bunkie: product requirements

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Summary

Bunkie is a virtual housing agent that helps corp members find a verified shared room with a host, for stays of 1 to 12 months, starting in Abuja.

Hosts already rent an apartment and have space to share. A host can be a corp member or anyone else. In version 1, only corp members can be tenants.

The agent interviews both sides, builds a profile each person approves, and matches them. The corp member views the room and pays only after both sides confirm. Bunkie takes a 2% fee and never holds the money.

Pitch options (choose one)

1. **Stay with a fellow corper while you find your feet,** for far less than a hotel or Airbnb.
2. **Don't beg for a place to stay.** Share with a verified host at a clear price, with clear rules and a clear end date.

Problem

A corp member leaving camp has only a few days to find somewhere to live, often in a city they do not know, on a monthly allowance.

The founder lived this: after camp, the only option was to beg a friend for a place to stay. The discomfort came from being there as a favour, with no agreed end date, no clear rules and the feeling of being a burden.

People with space to share have the opposite problem. They have no safe, simple way to earn from a spare room for a few months.

Option today	What goes wrong
Stay with a friend or relative	A favour with no terms or end date. Not possible for someone who knows nobody in the city.

Option today	What goes wrong
PPA accommodation, corpers' lodges, religious family houses	Free, but scarce in big cities, and quality varies.
Rent through a physical agent	Landlords usually want a year or more upfront, plus agent fees.
Hotel or Airbnb	Too expensive for more than a few nights.
WhatsApp and Telegram groups	Nobody is verified, and fake listings are common.

Users

There are two users: the corp member looking for a room, and the host offering one.

User	Who they are	What they need
Corp member (tenant)	Just out of camp with a PPA letter, little money and a few days to find a place.	A real room near their PPA, a total cost they can afford, a host they can trust, and no payment before they have seen the room.
Host	Already rents an apartment and has space to share. A serving corp member or any other resident.	Quick income from the space, a verified flatmate, and terms the tenant has agreed to in advance.

Corp members come with one of two needs:

- **Landing pad:** 1 to 3 months with a host, often a fellow corp member who can show them the city, while they look for their own place.
- **Service year stay:** 6 to 12 months sharing for most or all of the service year.

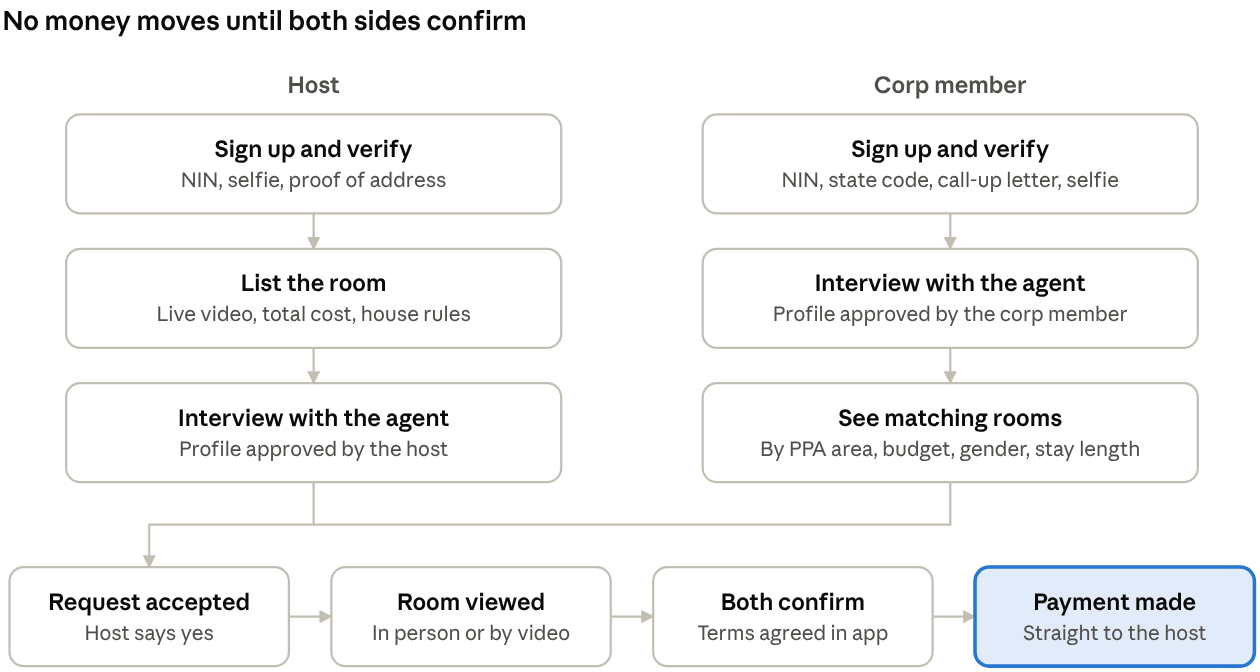
Product rules

Five decisions shape every feature in version 1.

Rule	What it means
Everyone is verified	Nobody lists a room or books one without passing identity checks.
Terms are clear before anyone moves	Price, house rules, refund rules and end date are agreed and recorded in the app.
Bunkie never holds money	The corp member pays only after both sides confirm, and the payment goes straight to the host.
The host sets the terms	Stay length, payment schedule, house rules and refund rules, within Bunkie's platform rules. The host is responsible for being allowed to share their apartment.
No team on the ground	Hosts upload everything themselves. Checks are automatic or done remotely.

How it works

Host and corp member each sign up, get verified and are interviewed separately, then meet at the booking.



host and corp member journeys · 3 steps each, 4 shared

The corp member views the room first and pays only after both sides confirm. The money goes straight to the host through Paystack, with Bunkie's fee split off. After move-in, each side rates whether the other's profile was accurate.

Requirements

Version 1 is a mobile-friendly web app, with WhatsApp used only for notifications. It needs the six capabilities below.

1. Verification

- Every user passes a NIN check through a paid identity service, a liveness selfie and a phone number check.
- Corp members also submit their state code and call-up letter. These are checked by hand at first, and each can be used by one account only.
- The name on the NIN must match the name on the call-up letter.
- Hosts also prove they live at the address with a prepaid meter number, utility bill or tenancy receipt.
- Nobody can list a room or book one until verified. Every profile shows a verified mark.

2. Host listing

- The host records a walkthrough video inside the app, with location stamped. Gallery uploads are not accepted.
- Costs are fixed fields: rent share, light, water, generator or inverter fuel, service charge, Wi-Fi and caution deposit. The app adds them into one total monthly cost.
- The host sets the stay lengths they accept, from 1 to 12 months, and whether payment is monthly or a lump sum.
- The host sets house rules on guests, cooking, smoking, pets and noise, with a consequence for breaking each one.
- The host sets the refund rules for early move-out, redeployment or being asked to leave.
- The host confirms they are allowed to share the apartment.
- The agent checks each listing for mismatches and flags odd ones for remote review.

3. Interview agent

- Before the first question, the person takes a one-line honesty pledge. A false profile can lead to removal.
- The agent asks about behaviour, not self-ratings: sleep times, guests, cooking, cleaning, noise.
- The agent drafts a profile. The person approves or edits it before anyone else sees it.
- The profile shows only what the person said and approved.

4. Matching

- Filter first by PPA area, total monthly cost, gender preference and stay length.
- Then rank the remaining rooms by profile fit.
- Show the corp member why each room was suggested.

5. Booking and payment

- The corp member sends a request and the host accepts or declines.
- The corp member can then view the room, in person or by video call. If it does not match the listing, they decline and report it.
- Both sides then confirm in the app. The app records the agreement: price, house rules, refund rules and end date.

- Only then does the corp member pay, through Paystack. The money goes straight to the host's bank account, with Bunkie's 2% fee split off.
- Bunkie never holds money. Nothing is paid before both sides confirm.

6. Safety and disputes

- Platform rules that host terms cannot override, such as a minimum notice period before asking a tenant to leave and no seizing of belongings.
- A report button for safety problems, with a fast remote response.
- In a dispute, the agent collects both sides and the evidence. A person makes the final decision remotely.
- After move-in, each side answers "Was their profile accurate?" Profiles marked inaccurate repeatedly lose standing.

Business model

Bunkie earns 2% of each booking, split off automatically when the corp member pays. At that rate, short stays earn almost nothing if Bunkie also pays Paystack's charge.

Paystack charges 1.5% + NGN 100 per local payment, capped at NGN 2,000 (Paystack pricing). If Bunkie absorbs it:

Booking	Bunkie's 2%	Paystack's charge	Left for Bunkie
NGN 50,000	NGN 1,000	NGN 850	NGN 150
NGN 100,000	NGN 2,000	NGN 1,600	NGN 400
NGN 300,000	NGN 6,000	NGN 2,000	NGN 4,000

- Other costs per booking are the identity checks and the agent's running costs.
- Every tenant leaves within a year, so revenue depends on volume across batches and on past tenants becoming hosts.

Goals and success measures

Version 1 succeeds if 20 corp members move in through Bunkie in the first full Abuja batch, with no serious complaints.

Goals

- A corp member can book a verified room near their PPA within days of leaving camp.
- Both sides know the price, the rules and the end date before anyone moves in.
- No money moves until both sides have agreed, and Bunkie never holds it.
- The product runs with nobody from the team physically present.

Success measures

- By-hand trial: 5 paid move-ins.
- First full batch: 20 move-ins with no serious complaints.
- After move-in, each side confirms the other's profile was accurate.

Not in version 1

- Dealing with landlords directly.
- Tenants who are not corp members.
- Reading social media accounts.
- Cities other than Abuja.
- A native mobile app.
- Physical inspections by the team.

Launch plan

Launch is city by city, starting with Abuja, and nothing is built until a by-hand trial shows people will pay.

1. **Prove it by hand (2 to 3 weeks).** Recruit 10 to 15 hosts among corp members already serving in Abuja, through CDS groups, corper WhatsApp and Telegram groups, and X. Collect listings with a form and match people manually. Goal: 5 paid move-ins.
2. **Build version 1 (4 to 6 weeks).** Build the six capabilities in the Requirements section, in that order.
3. **First full batch in Abuja.** Open sign-ups while corp members are still in camp, so they can book the week they get their PPA. Goal: 20 move-ins with no serious complaints.
4. **Strengthen and expand.** Add reviews and the full dispute process. Move to a second city once Abuja has worked for two batches.

Risks

The two risks that could end Bunkie are too few hosts at the start and a serious incident between matched flatmates.

Risk	How it is handled
Too few hosts at the start	Recruit the first 10 to 15 Abuja hosts by hand before building anything.
A serious incident between flatmates	Verify both sides, set platform rules hosts cannot override, and provide a report button.
Fake listings	In-app video with location, proof of address, and no payment before the corp member has seen the room.
Host and corp member meet through Bunkie, then pay each other directly to avoid the fee	Keep the fee small. The recorded agreement, receipt, reviews and dispute help apply only to bookings paid in the app.
Host's tenancy forbids sharing	The host is responsible, and confirms they are allowed to share when listing.
Thin margins	Decide who bears Paystack's charge, and rely on volume across batches.
Free alternatives such as lodges and family houses	Focus on big cities where they are scarce, and on the landing-pad stay.
People flatter themselves in the interview	Behaviour questions, answers visible to the flatmate, and the accuracy check after move-in.
Use of the NYSC name	No logo or implied endorsement without permission.
Handling of IDs and personal answers	Clear consent, store only what is needed, and a lawyer's review of the terms.

Open questions

Eight questions still need an answer before or during the build.

- [ ] Which pitch: "Stay with a fellow corper" or "Don't beg for a place to stay"?
- [ ] Who bears Paystack's charge: Bunkie, the corp member or the host?
- [ ] Is there a minimum fee for short stays?
- [ ] Which service runs the NIN checks? No free official API was found. Providers charge per check, for example Monnify at NGN 60.
- [ ] What is the minimum notice period: how many days' warning a host must give before asking a corp member to leave? Proposed: 7 days.
- [ ] Which refund rule can no host override? Proposed: a full refund if the host cancels or the room is not available on the agreed date.
- [ ] Who handles disputes and emergencies, and how fast must they respond?
- [ ] Are mixed-gender matches off by default?

One task also remains: find a lawyer to draft the standard agreement and platform terms.

Later

These are deliberately left out of version 1 and revisited once Abuja works.

- **Social media connection.** An optional way to enrich a profile from someone's posts, starting with one platform. The person still approves the profile.
- **Other tenants.** People visiting a Nigerian city for the first time who are not corp members.
- **More cities.** After Abuja has worked for two batches.
- **Host loop.** Prompt this year's tenants to host the next batch.
- **Native mobile app.**
- **NYSC partnership.** Not available now; revisit when Bunkie is bigger.